

ECON 1BB3: Introductory Macroeconomics

Spring 2026

Instructor Information

Instructor Name: Bridget O'Shaughnessy

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Office hours: Tuesdays, 11:00 am to 12:00 pm, EDT (via Zoom)
Zoom link posted on main course page of Avenue to Learn.

Course Information

Lectures: N/A

Labs: No

Tutorials: No

Course Dates: 2026/05/04- 2026/06/19

Units: 3.0

Course Delivery Mode: Online

Course Description: An introduction to the method and theory of macroeconomics, and their application to the analysis of contemporary economic problems.

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course you will know:

- why key economic variables are important and how they are measured.
- how models work in economics (especially diagrams) and how they are used to analyze “shocks”.
- economics is about people.

Course Learning Goals

Students should understand how macroeconomics variables work together to influence each other.

Materials and Fees

Textbook Title: Macroeconomics - required

ISBN: 978-0-13-768 850-0

Authors: Hubbard, O’Brian, Serletis, Childs

Publisher: Pearson Canada Inc.

Publication Date: 2024

Edition: 4th Canadian Ed.

Cost: \$102.95 (immediate access price); \$116.95 (regular price)

The textbook will be automatically billed to your McMaster account. There will be an opt-out option available for students who do not wish to purchase the book this way, or for students who wish to purchase the book directly from the publisher. More information will be available on Avenue once classes begin.

Textbook Listing: <https://campusstore.mcmaster.ca/Course/campus>

Online Homework Website – MyLab – required (included with purchase of textbook)

Avenue to Learn - Lecture videos are available through Avenue to Learn. Access to the MyLab online homework is also through Avenue to Learn. Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of this course, private information such as first and last names, usernames for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in this course will be deemed consent to this

disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure, please discuss this with the course instructor.

Course Evaluation

Online Quizzes – Avenue	80%
MyLab Assignments – Publisher’s website	7%
Participation (Discussion Posts) – Avenue	6%
Critical Reflection Questionnaires and Report - Avenue	7%

Course Evaluation Details

Online Quizzes

(AVENUE: “ASSESSMENTS” → “QUIZZES”)

There are six quizzes, beginning in Week 2 (see the schedule on page 8).

Quiz #1 – Ch. 1, 2, 3

Quiz #2 – Ch. 4, 5

Quiz #3 – Ch. 6, 7

Quiz #4 – Ch. 8, 9

Quiz #5 – Ch. 10, 11

Quiz #6 – Ch. 12, “diagram connections”

Your lowest quiz score will be dropped. The highest quiz score will be worth 20% of your final grade. The remaining four quizzes will be worth 15% each.

The quizzes will consist of 18 multiple choice questions (worth one point each) and one calculation question, where you will manually enter a numerical answer (worth two points). There is a 35-minute time limit for each quiz. You may or may not see a “countdown clock” during the quiz, depending on your browser choice and/or computer settings. Because you are taking the quiz on your own, we cannot invigilate the same way that we invigilate in-person tests. This means that you can use your notes and textbook during the quiz. You are expected to complete this quiz without the aid of other students. Quizzes will be held on Wednesdays

and will be available from 10:00 am until 10:00 pm EDT.

To ensure your success on the quizzes, please do the following:

- Use the latest version of either Chrome or Firefox.
- Close all other apps/programs/browser windows.
- Carefully read all instructions before beginning the quiz. The assigned time limit does not begin until you click "start quiz".
- You will see one question at a time, and you cannot move back and forth between questions.
- Once you have chosen your answer click "next question". Do **not** click "next question" more than once. Clicking more than once may result in the pop-up getting stuck and impeding your ability to read future questions. You will not be given any consideration should you make this mistake.
- When you have answered all questions, click "submit quiz". You must submit the quiz for it to be graded. Do **not** click "submit quiz" until you have answered all questions.
- If you miss the quiz, complete the online MSAF form. The rewrite will be Monday during the week following the missed quiz from 10:00 am to 10:00 pm EDT (5 days after the original quiz date).
- In the rare event that you should experience a technical problem, exit the quiz, and relaunch it. The clock will continue to run. If you begin a quiz, you cannot submit MSAF.
- The "drop lowest score" policy is meant to be insurance against (1) computer technical problems (2) internet service provider issues (3) you mistakenly submit the entire quiz after completing only a few questions (4) any other even that causes you to have a started, but incomplete, quiz. If you miss a quiz completely, your first course of action should be to submit MSAF and take the rewrite. If you rely on this "drop lowest score" policy for a missed quiz, and then later in the course you experience technical difficulties, or submission mistakes, you will **not** be given any special consideration.
- Quiz 6 includes some questions that cover diagram analysis from more than one chapter. This is not a cumulative quiz, and it is not a final exam.
- If you would like feedback on which quiz questions you got wrong, please email me **after** the MSAF rewrite date.

Quiz Access

(AVENUE: "ASSESSMENTS →"QUIZZES)

A "course outline" quiz will be made available on Avenue beginning on the first day of classes (May 4), or earlier. It is due at 10:00 pm EST on Wednesday, May 13. You cannot access the first content quiz until you achieve a score of 10/10 on the course outline quiz.

MyLab Homework

(publisher's website, linked from Avenue homepage)

- Online homework will be submitted using the publisher's website. You can purchase from the campus store or from the publisher during the registration process. Do not attempt to create a MyLab account until after classes begin and you can access MyLab from within Avenue. Do not purchase directly from the publisher's website, or another website, as your access may not be guaranteed.
- The first three homework assignments are due on Tuesday, May 12, at 10:00 pm. One is a review of some basic math concepts called "MyLab Math Review," the other is an introduction to the online platform called "How to Use MyLab". Each of these homework assignments is worth 1% of your final grade. If you miss either of these homework assignments, you may submit an MSAF. The new due date will be the following Monday, at 10:00 pm.
- There are 12 graded homework assignments, each associated with a chapter in the textbook. Homework is due on Tuesday night at 10:00pm. Make sure that your computer is set to the correct time zone (Eastern Daylight Time) so that the due dates show up as 10:00pm. Due to the timing of the drop/add period, the homework for chapters 1, 2, and 3 are all due during week 2.
- You have two "free passes" for missed weekly chapter homework. You may use your free passes if you are ill, forget a due date, or have computer problems. You do not need a doctor's note or need to contact anyone to use a free pass. Given the "free pass" policy, I will grade only your top 10 (each is worth 0.5% of your final grade). MSAF will not be accepted for the MyLab weekly chapter homework. If you do not use any of the "free passes" your lowest two homework grades will be dropped. Please note that a free pass may *not* be used if you miss the math review or the "how-to" assignment – see the second bullet point above.
- You can only review homework that you have opened. Even if you cannot complete the homework one week, it is a good idea to open it and submit one answer. Then that homework will be available for you to review as you prepare for quizzes.

Participation

(AVENUE: “COMMUNICATION →DISCUSSIONS”)

During Week 2 of the course, you will be asked to introduce yourself to some peers via the discussion board on Avenue. During the remainder of the course, you are expected to actively participate in online discussion forums. An assignment sheet which will outline instructions, a detailed grade breakdown, submission details and guidelines, will be provided. Each “Discussion Post Response Set” includes a “Personal Response” to a question, which will be due on Tuesdays and a “Peer Response” to the same question, which will be due on Thursdays. The “Peer Response” must be in the form of a reply to one other student’s post. Failure to follow the naming conventions for discussion posts will result in a grade of zero for that post. If you miss a discussion post, you can submit MSAF. The new due date is the Monday of the week following the missed post. If a single student submits MSAF for a discussion post, the entire class will see that the discussion topic is available until the following Monday. However, only students who submit MSAF will have late posts graded. Posts that are submitted after the due date will be given a grade of zero.

Critical Reflection

(AVENUE: “ASSESSMENTS”→”QUIZZES” AND “ASSESSMENTS”→”ASSIGNMENTS”)

You will complete a brief questionnaire during weeks 3, 5, and 7, and then use those to write and submit a final critical reflection report of 400 to 500 words. The report is due Friday, June 19. The questionnaires will be available via Avenue quizzes. If you miss a questionnaire, you can submit MSAF. The new due date is the Monday of the week following the missed questionnaire. The report will be submitted on Avenue through “Assessments”>”Assignments”. An assignment sheet for the report, which will outline instructions, a detailed grade breakdown, submission details and guidelines, will be provided. If you miss the deadline for the report you can submit MSAF. The new due date is Monday, June 23.

Grading Scale

Grades will be based on the McMaster University grading scale:

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100
A	11	85-89
A-	10	80-84
B+	9	77-79
B	8	73-76
B-	7	70-72
C+	6	67-69

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
C	5	63-66
C-	4	60-62
D+	3	57-59
D	2	53-56
D-	1	50-52
F	0	0-49

Grade Adjustment Techniques:

Standard rounding rules will be used. Any decimal ending in a 0.5 to 0.9 will be rounded up. Any decimal ending in a 0.0 to 0.4 will be rounded down. For example, 74.5 rounds to 75 and 74.4 rounds to 74.

Absences, Missed Work or Illness

Term tests:

If you miss a term test you will receive a grade of zero unless you follow McMaster guidelines for “Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work” in the Undergraduate Calendar. You may use the online reporting tool, MSAF (self-report), for **one** absence per term due to medical/personal reasons, if the absence is three days or less, and for work worth less than 25% of your final grade. In terms of this course, you may use the self-report MSAF form ***only*** for Test #1. The MSAF “Self Report” and “Missed Work” forms are available in the Student Centre in Mosaic.

If you miss Term Test #2, you must email your Faculty office (ex. Social Sciences, Commerce, Science, Engineering, etc....) to ask for consideration for an “administrative report” MSAF. They may require documentation. Upon submitting the MSAF form, you will be instructed to email your professor – please do not email us, as we have too many such emails to respond to individually. If you missed the test and submitted an MSAF online form, you will see “100/30 (100/40)” for your test score. This lets you know that we DID receive the MSAF notification and that we will be transferring the weight of this test to your final exam. If you see “0/30 (0/40)” or “-/30 (-/40)” then we do not have a record of an MSAF being submitted and you should contact econia@mcmaster.ca.

In the case of a missed test, **the weight will be transferred to the final exam**. Missing an early write test does not entitle you to write the test on the Saturday morning – if you signed up for the early write and you are ill, you should complete the online MSAF form (or see your Faculty office) and the weight will be transferred to your final exam. Make-up tests will not be given under any circumstances.

Turnitin.com

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For students using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Course Modification

The instructor and university reserve the right to modify elements of the course during the term. The university may change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances. If either type of modification becomes necessary, reasonable notice and communication with the students will be given with an explanation and the opportunity to comment on changes. It is the responsibility of the student to check their McMaster email and course websites weekly during the term and to note any changes.

Generative AI

Generative AI: Use Prohibited

Students are not permitted to use generative AI in this course. In alignment with [McMaster academic integrity policy](#), it “shall be an offence knowingly to ... submit academic work for assessment that was purchased or acquired from another source”. This includes work created by generative AI tools. Also state in the policy is the following, “Contract Cheating is the act of “outsourcing of student work to third parties” (Lancaster & Clarke, 2016, p. 639) with or without payment.” Using Generative AI tools is a form of contract cheating. Charges of academic dishonesty will be brought forward to the Office of Academic Integrity.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: “Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty”), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/), located at <https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/>

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one’s own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Authenticity / Plagiarism

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. **All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld** (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster’s use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Email Communication

Effective September 1, 2010, it is the policy of the Faculty of Social Sciences that all e-mail communication sent from students to instructors (including Tasks), and from students to staff, must originate from the student's own McMaster University e-mail account. This policy protects confidentiality and confirms the identity of the student. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that communication is sent to the university from a McMaster account. If an instructor becomes aware that a communication has come from an alternate address, the instructor may not reply at his/her/their discretion.

Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, usernames for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure, please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the "Code"). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students' access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28 652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University's [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office ***normally within 10 working days*** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.

Course Schedule (and/or Important Dates)

Week	Content Released	Assignments/Quizzes	Due Date
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1	Chapters 1-3	Nothing due, drop/add date is Monday, May 11	
2	Chapters 4, 5	Introduction Discussion Post	Tues., May 12*
		Discussion Post Personal Response #1	Tues., May 12
		Discussion Post Peer Response #1	Thurs., May 14
		MyLab Math, How-to Assignments	Tues., May 12
		MyLab HK (Chapters 1-3)	Tues., May 12
		Quiz #1 – Avenue (Chapters 1-3)**	Wed., May 13
3	Chapters 6, 7	MyLab HK (Chapters 4, 5)	Tues., May 19
		Critical Reflection Questionnaire #1	Wed., May 20
		Quiz #2 – Avenue (Chapters 4, 5)	Wed., May 20
4	Chapters 8, 9	Discussion Post Personal Response #2	Tues., May 26
		Discussion Post Peer Response #2	Thurs., May 28
		MyLab HK (Chapters 6, 7)	Tues., May 26
		Quiz #3 – Avenue (Chapters 6, 7)	Wed., May 27
5	Chapters 10, 11	MyLab HK (Chapters 8, 9)	Tues., June 2
		Critical Reflection Questionnaire #2	Wed., June 3
		Quiz #4 – Avenue (Chapters 8, 9)	Wed., June 3
6	Chapter 12	Discussion Post Personal Response #3	Tues., June 9
		Discussion Post Peer Response #3	Thurs., June 11
		MyLab HK (Chapters 10, 11)	Tues., June 9
		Quiz #5 – Avenue (Chapters 10,11)	Wed., June 10
7		MyLab HK (Chapter 12)	Tues., June 16
		Critical Reflection Questionnaire #3	Tues., June 16
		Quiz #6 – Avenue (Chapter 12, “Diagram Connections”)	Wed., June 17
		Critical Reflection Report	Fri., June 19

*All work is due at 10:00 pm.

**To access Quiz #1 you must score 10/10 on the course outline quiz (see the section called “Quiz Access” on page 3)